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Immunology
Competitive Intelligence Update

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FDA approved Sotyktu for active PsA

Company: BMS

Drug: Sotyktu (deucravacitinib, oral TYK2 inhibitor)

Date: March 6th, 2026

Source(s): Press release, FDA label

What happened:

- On its March 6th PDUFA date, the FDA approved Sotyktu (deucravacitinib, oral TYK2 inhibitor) for the treatment of adults with active psoriatic arthritis (PsA)
    - Approval is based on the positive results from the Phase 3 POETYK PsA-1 and POETYK PsA-2 studies
    - Approved dosage: 6mg once daily in adults
    - Consistent with the PsO label, Sotyktu is associated with the following warnings and precautions: hypersensitivity reactions, infections, tuberculosis, malignancy including lymphomas, rhabdomyolysis and elevated CPK, laboratory abnormalities, immunizations, and potential risks related to JAK inhibition
- The FDA label and HCP website have been updated; the patient website has not been updated yet to reflect the approval

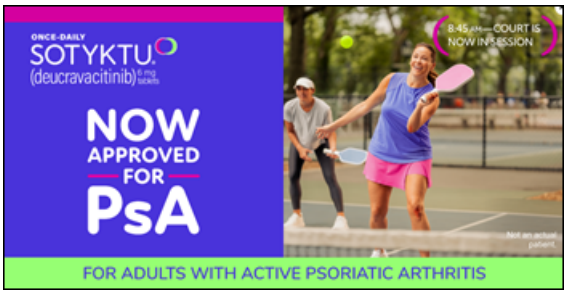
Impact (CI PoV): HIGH

- The FDA approval makes Sotyktu the first and only oral TYK2 inhibitor approved for adults with active PsA, expanding its 2022 approval in moderate-to-severe plaque psoriasis (PsO)
    - *This approval allows BMS to establish early physician familiarity and real-world evidence ahead of emerging oral competitors such as JNJ's*

Icotyde (icotrokinra, oral IL-23R antagonist) and Takeda's Zasocitinib (TAK-279, oral TYK2 inhibitor), with approvals expected in Q1 2028 and Q3 2028, respectively

Why it matters:

- The approval offers a new once-daily oral option that may appeal to patients seeking an alternative to injectable biologics while potentially providing a more manageable safety and monitoring profile than JAK inhibitors



Tell me more:

- FDA approval is supported by the Phase 3 multicenter, randomized, double-blind, placebo-controlled POETYK-PsA-1 and POETYK-PsA-2 trials that evaluated the safety and efficacy of Sotyktu in adults with active PsA
- **Study Design**
  - POETYK PsA-1 included 670 patients with active PsA who were bDMARD naïve
  - POETYK PsA-2 included 624 patients with active PsA who were bDMARD naïve or had previously received TNFα inhibitor treatment; the trial also included an apremilast safety reference arm
  - Primary endpoint: ACR20 at Week 16
- **Study Results**
  - Efficacy:

- Both trials met their primary endpoints, demonstrating sustained improvements across joint pain and swelling as well as psoriatic skin lesions

	PsA-1			PsA-2		
Endpoint	*Sotyktu* (N=336)	Placebo (N=334)	Difference from Placebo (95% CI)	*Sotyktu* (N=312)	Placebo (N=312)	Difference from Placebo (95% CI)
ACR20 response, %	54[b]	34	20(12, 27)	54[b]	39	15 (7, 23)
ACR50 response, %	24	14	11 (5, 17)	29	16	13 (6, 19)
ACR70 response, %	12	5	6 (2, 10)	10	5	5 (1, 9)
Minimal disease activity response, %	19[c*]	10	9 (4, 14)	26[c†]	15	11 (5, 17)

- Safety:
  - The overall safety profile in active PsA was generally consistent with the safety profile previously seen in PsO
  - Most common adverse reactions were upper respiratory infections, increased blood creatine phosphokinase, herpes simplex, mouth ulcers, folliculitis, and acne
- HRQoL:
  - Improvements were seen in SF-36 PCS score at Week 16 compared to placebo (key secondary endpoint)
  - Improvements were also reported across all four SF-36 PCS domain scale scores: physical functioning, role-physical, bodily pain, and general health

- **Outlook:**
  - Regulatory applications for Sotyktu are under review in the EU, Japan and China
  - **Pediatric PsA**: Phase 3 study ongoing; PCD: March 2030
  - **SLE:** Phase 3 POETYK-SLE-1 & POETYK-SLE-2 ongoing, with data expected in 2026; PCDs: October 2026;

- **SjD:** Phase 3 POETYK-SjS-1 ongoing, with data expected in 2027; PCD: November 2026